

tion and your competency level.

M.M.T. Nambi, vice president-aviation and business consulting at Ramco Systems, says, "The compensation package is dependent on the domain knowledge and nature of experience that the person carries and will be above Rs 600,000 for a person having over four-six years of experience."

Make yourself industry-ready

Now that you have received enough boosters about the opportunities to be grabbed in the aerospace field, it's time to learn how to get an edge over others in the job market and hone your employable skills accordingly.

Although experienced applicants are always preferred by the companies

guidance, and aeroelasticity. All these specialisations are usually referred to as mechanical streams of aeronautical engineering. Specialisation in automatic control and avionics comes under electronics stream.

Electronics has become an inherent part of today's aircrafts and spacecrafts, and provides crucial state information like position, orientation and velocity, which is essential for safe operation of the craft. Avionics basically stands for aviation electronics, though the term is not limited to just aviation anymore and is extended to rockets, spacecraft, etc. Avionics deals with the electronic systems of aircrafts used for navigation, guidance and communication. The subject matter comes under electronics communication. (At IIT Kharagpur,

high-tech and fast-changing field, so one needs to be always abreast of the global technology advances in the field. Design and analysis jobs involve abstract modelling and complex calculations, so one needs to be very comfortable with those and a strong mathematics background is necessary too. Also, due to the high-tech nature of the field, creative thinking is a skill that is often sought."

Another professor from IIT Bombay says: "If recruiters are from the core sector, they primarily look for strong fundamentals and also in some cases knowledge in the specialisation including use of certain specialised tools (usually software)."

But remember hard skills alone won't take you anywhere. Apart from technical knowledge, most companies prefer candidates who have mastered some soft skills, particularly communication skills. They also go for people who are proactive, good team players, ready to accept challenges and grasp things quickly. It is these basic qualities that may at times set one candidate apart from the other.

Since companies have specialised job requirements that cannot be taught in a typical classroom (lack of commonality), it is a standard practice to recruit trainees. During the training, the employees are exposed to the various facets of the company's activities and also gauged for suitability to work on these activities. They are then posted as engineers and subsequently as lead engineers/project engineers and then onto more management-oriented roles.

"We at Ramco Systems look for a fairly good understanding of aircraft maintenance and engineering principles, process orientation (ability to think process), and good writing and oral communication skills," adds Nambi.

To sum it up, companies, while recruiting, look at the combination of a consistent academic record, deep understanding of the subject matter and good communications skills. ●

The aerospace engineers from our institute have joined IT companies and also the knowledge process outsourcing (KPO)

companies—Dr M.R. Patkar, director, Indian Institute for Aeronautical Engineering and Information Technology (IIAEIT), Pune



in aerospace, recruiters, while hiring a fresher, usually look for the technical and problem-solving skills of the student. In general, core companies look for the basic knowledge and understanding of the subject matter and IT companies look for coding skills and aptitude.

As a student of aerospace engineering, you will be involved in all aspects of aeronautics and related areas like automobiles, wind energy, power generation, ship and submarine design, non-destructive testing, consultancy and construction works. You will also need to specialise in one of the many areas such as aerodynamics (theoretical aerodynamics, experimental aerodynamics and computational fluid dynamics), propulsion, flight mechanics, orbital mechanics, structures (structural mechanics, structural dynamics, computational structural mechanics and vibration), stability, control and

the subject is offered as an elective to senior undergraduate students.)

Hence, while studying for this branch of engineering, you have an opportunity to accumulate knowledge which can be used in various diversified industries. It's no surprise that aerospace engineers can and do fit in various industries besides those devoted to aeronautics, astronautics and space.

However, you obviously need to know what's in demand there.

Prof. Sinhamahapatra informs, "No formal specialisation is offered by IIT Kharagpur in aerospace engineering but companies look for people who are experts in tackling problems related to one or more of the following fields: computational fluid dynamics, aerodynamics, computational structural analysis, aircraft structures, control and guidance, and propulsion systems."

On the other hand, Prof. Sriram of IIT Madras says, "Aerospace is a